

Petition 1 — Enhancement of Agricultural Electricity Connection to 5 HP for Deep Borewells in the Chittur Rain-Shadow Belt

To: Shri Sunny Joseph Hon'ble Minister for Electricity, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri T. Siddique, Hon'ble Minister for Agriculture 2. Shri Mons Joseph, Hon'ble Minister for Water Resources (Irrigation & Ground Water)

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to permit and expedite agricultural electricity connections up to **5 HP** (and, where justified, above 5 HP) for deep irrigation borewells in the rain-shadow panchayats of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy, Kozhinjampara and adjoining areas of the Chittur block.

1. Respected Sir,

We are farmer-representatives of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara. We respectfully place before you the acute irrigation-power difficulty faced by the farmers of the eastern, rain-shadow part of the Chittur Assembly constituency, and pray for your intervention.

2. The factual position

- 1. Kerala's driest belt.** Chittur — and in particular Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara — lies in the Palakkad Gap **rain-shadow region**, the driest tract in Kerala. Annual rainfall here is only about **1,000 mm (and often less)**, against the State average of roughly **3,000 mm** — barely **one-third** of the State average. The surrounding hills block the rain-bearing winds.
- 2. A "Critical" groundwater block.** As per the Central Ground Water Board's *National Compilation on Dynamic Ground Water Resources of India (2023 and 2024)*, **Chittur is one of only two or three "Critical" groundwater blocks in the entire State of Kerala** (along with Malampuzha and Kasaragod), where the stage of groundwater extraction is between 90% and 100%.
- 3. Deepening borewells.** Because surface water is scarce and rainfall is low, farmers depend almost entirely on borewells. Water tables have fallen steeply — borewells that were once 400–600 ft now increasingly **cross 800–1,000 ft** in these panchayats.
- 4. The power bottleneck — the exact legal position.** Following the groundwater regime tightened after the Plachimada (Perumatty panchayat) bottling-plant water controversy: - Under the **Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Act, 2002 (Act 19 of 2003)** and the **Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Rules, 2004**, the Government, exercising powers under **Section 6(1)**, notified certain areas as "notified areas." By **G.O.(P) No. 58/2005/WRD dated 19-11-2005**, **Chittoor (Palakkad District) was declared a notified area** (along with Athiyannur, Kodungalloor, Kozhikode and Kasaragode). - Consequently, under **Section 7** of the Act, extraction of groundwater in Chittoor requires a **permit from the Kerala State Ground Water Authority**. - By **KSEB Board Circular dated 05-06-2007 (Circular_Control_05-06-2007)**, the Board directed that an **electric connection to any open well / borewell within a notified area shall be given only on production of the Ground Water Authority permit**, treating that permit as a statutory clearance — in line with the proviso to **Clause 6(1) of the Kerala Electricity Supply Code** (now the **Kerala Electricity Supply Code, 2014**). - Under the Ground Water Department's operating practice, the **District-level committee sanctions motors only in the 3–5 HP band**, and motors **above 5 HP require State-level authority** approval, so in practice farmers in this belt are effectively held at around **3 HP**, with long delays for anything higher. - Further, before the borewell / EB line is

approved, the **Ground Water Authority requires the farmer to install a water flow meter on the well and submit its readings**, and grants the extraction/conversion permit **subject to a ceiling on daily extraction** fixed on the basis of a **yield test**. In our critical-zone belt these flow-meter, daily-log and yield-test conditions are difficult and impractical for small and marginal farmers to comply with and add further delay to obtaining the EB connection.

5. **Why 3 HP is not enough.** A 3 HP pump simply cannot lift adequate water from a borewell that is 800–1,000 ft deep. The result is that farms cannot be irrigated even where a valid well exists, causing crop loss and distress among paddy, banana, coconut and vegetable growers who have no alternative source of water.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister to:

1. **Sanction agricultural EB connections up to 5 HP as the norm** for genuine cultivators in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy, Kozhinjampara (and comparable critical-zone areas of Chittur block) where the certified borewell depth exceeds a reasonable threshold (e.g. 500/800 ft), on production of the Ground Water Authority permit.
2. **Expedite and simplify** clearances for connections **above 5 HP** in genuinely deep borewells, on the basis of a well-depth certificate, without routine referral delays.
3. Establish a **single-window** so that the Ground Water Authority permit and the KSEB connection are processed together within a fixed time limit.
4. **Retain the concessional LT-VA agricultural tariff** for these enhanced-HP irrigation connections.
5. **Make the flow-meter, daily-log and yield-test conditions practical** — for genuine small and marginal farmers in these panchayats, simplify or relax the mandatory flow-meter installation and daily-reading requirement (e.g. a one-time meter with periodic reading, or exemption below a threshold HP/depth), and fix crop-based, realistic daily-extraction ceilings, so that these conditions do not delay or block the EB connection.
6. Consider **dedicated agricultural feeders and solar-pump support (PM-KUSUM / State schemes)** so that the higher connected load does not raise the farmer's cost, and to make deep-borewell irrigation energy-efficient (paired with drip/micro-irrigation).

We are willing to furnish panchayat-wise lists of affected farmers, borewell-depth data and pending connection applications.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Panchayat-wise list of affected farmers and pending/limited connections.
- Annexure B: Borewell depth certificates / sample.
- Annexure C: CGWB categorisation extract for Chittur block.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Annexure — Draft Government Order (model, for the Government's consideration)

The following is a model draft placed for the Government's consideration. The actual G.O. number, date and file references are to be assigned by the Department.

GOVERNMENT OF KERALA

Abstract

Power (Electricity) Department — Agricultural electric connections in the notified "critical" ground-water areas of Chittoor block, Palakkad District — Enhancement of permissible motor capacity up to 5 HP for deep bore-wells and single-window clearance — Sanctioned — Orders issued.

POWER (ELECTRICITY) DEPARTMENT

G.O.(Ms) No. ____/2026/PD Thiruvananthapuram, dated __-__-2026

Read: 1. The Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Act, 2002 (Act 19 of 2003) and Rules, 2004.
2. G.O.(P) No. 58/2005/WRD dated 19-11-2005 (notified areas).
3. KSEB Board Circular dated 05-06-2007.
4. Representation dated 15-07-2026 of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, forwarded by the MLA, Chittur.

ORDER

Whereas Chittoor block is a notified area under the Act read above (2) and one of the "Critical" ground-water blocks of the State; and whereas bore-wells in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara now commonly exceed 800–1,000 ft, for which a 3 HP pump-set is technically insufficient;

Government, having considered the matter, hereby order that —

- (1) KSEB Ltd. shall sanction agricultural (LT-VA) connections up to 5 HP as a matter of course to genuine cultivators in the said panchayats, on production of the Ground Water Authority permit, where the certified bore-well depth exceeds [500/800] ft;
- (2) applications for connections above 5 HP for genuinely deep bore-wells shall be disposed by the State Ground Water Authority within [30] days on the basis of a well-depth certificate;
- (3) a single-window mechanism shall process the GWA permit and the KSEB connection together within a fixed time-limit;
- (4) the Ground Water Authority's flow-meter, daily-log and yield-test conditions shall be made practical for small/marginal farmers (one-time meter with periodic reading or exemption below a threshold; realistic, crop-based daily-extraction ceilings) so as not to delay the EB line;
- (5) the concessional LT-VA agricultural tariff shall continue to apply; and
- (6) the Department shall examine dedicated agricultural feeders / PM-KUSUM solar-pump support for the belt.

By order of the Governor,

Secretary to Government

To The Chairman & Managing Director, KSEB Ltd.

The Member Secretary, Kerala State Ground Water Authority.

Copy to: Agriculture Dept.; Water Resources Dept.; the MLA, Chittur.